280 **that 'the Almighty, through his eternal favours and perpetual grace':** Akbar's letter to the wise men of Christendom, Muktabat i allami, Dafter I, letters to the emperor.

281 **'stood every morning opposite to the window':** Badauni, *Muntakhabh al-Tawarikh*, Vol. 2, p. 336.

281 **'As the world's Lord exercises sway over it':** Mukhia, *The Mughals in India*, p. 58.

281 **just prescribe a passive 'tolerance':** Ibid.

281 **'blowing of the chill blast':** Jarrett (trans.), *Ain-i Akbari*, Vol. 3, p. 3.

281 **Devotion to the Matchless one is beyond the limits of the spoken:** Khan, *India's Polity in the Age of* Akbar, p. 164.

282 **Tusi and Rumi, which were among Akbar's favourite texts:** Alam, *The Languages of Political Islam*, p. 61.

282 **Thou has come to unite:** Alam, 'State building under the Mughals: Religion, Culture and Politics'; *Cahiers d'asie centrale*, Vol. 3/4, Editions de Boccard, 1997, p. 119.

282 **The best prayer is service to humanity:** Ibid., pp. 62–64.

282 **'within this framework there was no scope for the operation':** Khan, *India's Polity in the Age of Akbar*, p. 16.

282 **'As in the wide expanse of the Divine compassion there is room for all classes':** Rogers (trans.), *Tuzuk-i-Jahangiri*, p. 37.

283 **'by the end of Akbar's reign, Kacchwaha mansabdars':** Eaton, *India in the Persianate Age*, p. 230.

283 **'If people really wished it':** Frederic P. Miller, Agnes F. Vandome, and John McBrewster (eds.), *Dabestan-e Mazaheb*, New Delhi: VPN Publishing, 2010 (repr.).

284 **as 'Ordinances of the Divine Faith' and the idea of Din-e Ilahi:** M. Athar Ali and M. Akhtar Ali, 'Sulhi kul and the Religious Ideas of Akbar', *Proceedings of the Indian History Congress*, Vol. 41, 1980, p. 330.

284 **they also contained the emperor's name:** Moin, *The Millennial Sovereign*, p. 222.

284 **'God is Great/May his Glory be ever Glorious':** Ibid.

285 **'If discipleship means willingness to sacrifice one's life':** Badauni, *Muntakhabh al-Tawarikh*, Vol. 2, p. 375.

286 **'They have been rulers who commanded great power and authority':** Husain, *The Nobility Under Akbar and Jahāngīr*, p. 217.

285 **'you are making all these delays in coming; evidently the wool of your beard':** Shāhnavāz Khān Awrangābādī, ʿAbd al-Ḥayy ibn Shāhnavāz, and Baini Prashad, *The Maāthir-ul-umarā: Being Biographies of the Muhammadan and Hindu Officers of the Timurid Sovereigns of India from 1500 to About 1780 A. D.*, Asiatic Society, 1979, p. 325.

286 **'not a sound was emitted from the silent house nor any speech':** Moosvi, *Episodes in the Life of Akbar*, p. 91.

287 **'At fixed hours, namely before dawn':** Monserrate, *The Commentary of Father Monserrate*, p. 211.

287 **'likewise an excellent hand in performing':** Blochmann (trans.), *Ain-i Akbari*, Vol. 1, p. 51.

287 **'is visible from outside the awning':** Kumar, 'Rituals of Power', *Proceedings of the IHC*, Vol. 58, 1997, p. 246.

288 **'It will seem little short of miraculous':** Monserrate, *The Commentary of Father Monserrate*, p. 200.

288 **'He knew the names of all his elephants':** du Jarric, *Akbar and the Jesuits*, p. 207.

289 **'He is much loved as well as feared by his people':** Henriquez quoted in Moosvi, *Episodes in the Life of Akbar*, p. 81.

289 **'His majesty from curiosity likes to see spider fights'**: Blochmann (trans.), *Ain-i Akbari*, Vol. 1, p. 296.